Sonsam and Lahdeli: the Delian Bond on the Twinned Octet, with Ian Dury, Blockhead and Keyed Switch Points



Theorem: on the holes of ideal hexagonal close packing (the twinned octet) the weight walk of paper #53 passes, exactly, through the octet, then one point where all pieces have equal volume √2/6 (Sonsam and Lahdeli, at the single root of an irreducible cubic), then a stop of Ian Durys and 60° rhombohedra (13√2/54 and √2/54), and ends in Blockheads alone (√2/4); on the cubic octet the same walk goes from the octet straight to cubes, with Samson and Delilah equal at $\lambda = 3/8 - \sqrt[3]{4}/4$.

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Paper #56 · Version 1 · 25 October 2026 · DICTO DOI: reserved on publication · Licence CC BY-SA 4.0 · Scripts, exact checks and data: https://github.com/DICTOR-Master/kaleidohedra/tree/1928b53/studies/2026-10-25-hidden-bonds, studies/2026-10-25-sunstar-keyed and papers/2026-10-25-keyed-switch/checks (research branch, commit 1928b53)
The ideas are DICTO's: that further bonds may be "hiding in plain sight" in the census networks; other rhythms of volume (doubling, tripling); a different but cohesive bond network beside the golden and Delian ones; keyed versions of the new pairs; and the names Sonsam, Lahdeli, Ian Dury, Blockhead and the -K forms (25 October 2026). Computation, exact proofs and drafting with Claude (Anthropic).

In short. This paper is about webs of bonds: when pieces fill space, each shared face is a bond, and the bonds together make a network that rewires as the pieces change (#52, #53 [6, 1]). Here we follow that network on a second stacking, and show that keys change the pieces but never the network. Stack layers of balls in the cubic way and the gaps between them are octahedra and tetrahedra: the octet. Stack them in the hexagonal way, each layer a mirror image of the one two below, and the gaps are the same octahedra and tetrahedra, joined across the mirror planes: the twinned octet. Paper #53 [1] slid one number, a weight, between the two kinds of gap and recorded every way space splits on the way. On the cubic octet, at one exact weight, $\lambda = 3/8 - \sqrt[3]{4}/4$ (the cube root of the old Delian problem), the two pieces have equal volume: DICTO's Samson and Delilah [3]. We follow the same walk on the twinned octet. It has its own equal-volume point, at the single root of an irreducible cubic; there the two pieces are new solids, which DICTO named **Sonsam** (19 corners, one face a nine-sided polygon lying on the mirror plane) and **Lahdeli** (12 corners), the syllables swapped as the stacking is mirrored. Further on, the twinned walk makes a stop the cubic walk does not have: **Ian Dury** (16 corners) with the classical 60° rhombohedron; and where the cubic walk ends in cubes the twinned one ends in **Blockheads** (10 corners), the twin of the cube. Every volume is exact: √2/6, 13√2/54, √2/54, √2/4. Moving a cap from one piece into its neighbour keeps the tiling and its web of bonds; done with the new pairs this gives DICTO's keyed forms Sonsam-K and Lahdeli-K, and Ian Dury-K with Rhombo-K, a six-pointed star. Finally we read DICTO's Sunstar lattice (#42 [4]) in the same light: it is rock salt's switch point (#53) keyed with Euclid's roofs. The two new walks' pieces and the keyed forms were not found in the sources checked.

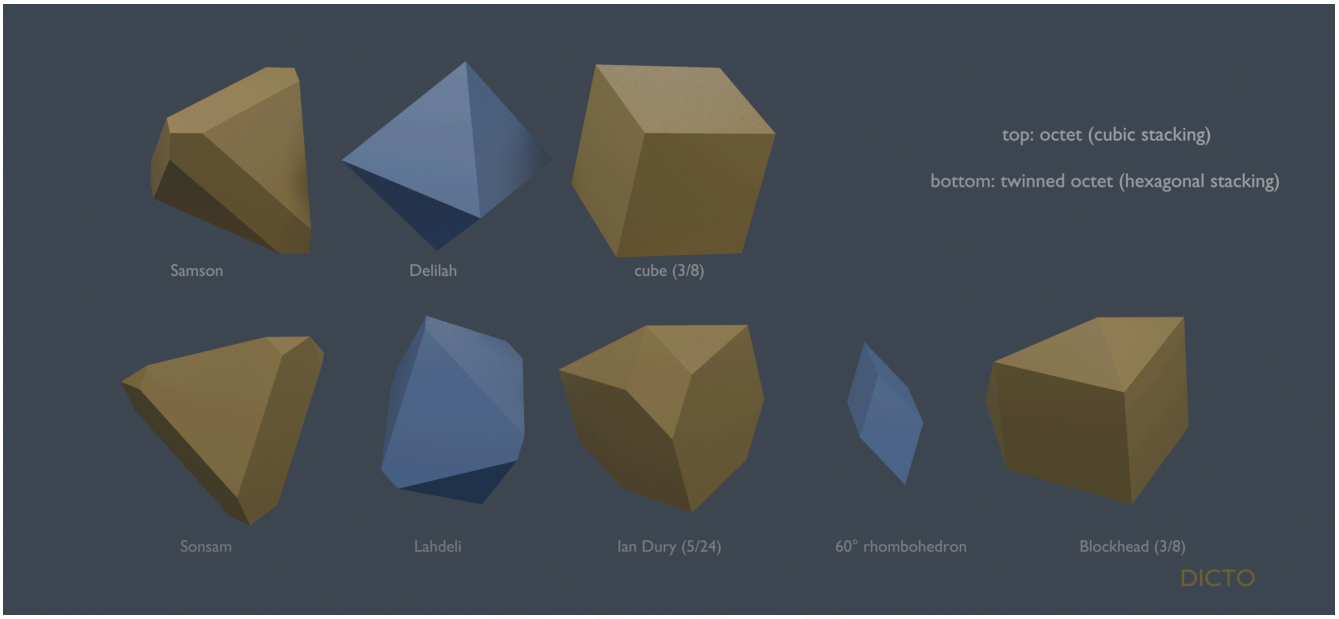


Figure 1. Top: the cubic octet walk, Samson and Delilah at equal volume, then cubes at λ = 3/8. Bottom: the twinned walk, Sonsam and Lahdeli at equal volume, Ian Dury with the 60° rhombohedron at λ = 5/24, Blockhead at λ = 3/8. Same scale throughout.

1. Where it started

After #53 and #55 [1, 2] DICTO theorised that more bonds might be "hiding in plain sight" in the census networks, proposed other rhythms of volume than equality (doubling, tripling), and proposed looking for a bond network "similar but different" to the golden and the Delian. We searched the seven three-dimensional census walks for points where the two kinds of piece stand in a simple volume ratio (1, 2, 3, 4 and their inverses, $\varphi^{\pm 1}$, $\varphi^{\pm 2}$, $1 + \sqrt{2}$). Most of them give no new shape: on rock salt and zinc blende the ratio passes every value with the same two shapes, and the Laves phase gives the classical Frank–Kasper cells. One walk did give new shapes: the twinned octet. DICTO then proposed keyed versions of the new pairs, and named them all.

2. The set-up

> *Plain words: each gap gets a share of space; a weight decides how big a share; slide it and the shares change shape.*

The sites are the octahedral and tetrahedral holes of ideal hexagonal close packing (ball spacing 1): per cell two octahedral and four tetrahedral sites, cell volume $\sqrt{2}$. Each site gets a weight, $w_{oct} = 0$ and $w_{tet} = \lambda$, and owns the points x with $|x - p|^2 - w_p$ smallest: a power diagram [5], whose cells are convex, fill space face to face and change only at isolated values of λ. Two cells sharing a face are bonded [6]. Units and λ are those of the census [1] (data file hcpholes), the same as for the cubic octet ("delian") there, so the two walks compare directly. Exact computations are in $\mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{2})$ and in the exact real roots of integer polynomials (sympy), with the census engine; the keyed solids are float constructions (manifold3d) with the checks stated.

3. Main theorem

> **Theorem.** On the twinned octet the walk has, for $-1/8 \le \lambda \le 3/8$, exactly these stops and pieces:

1. $\lambda = -1/8$: the octet's regular octahedra and tetrahedra, twinned.
2. On $-1/8 < \lambda < 5/24$ every tetrahedral site has the same cell, a solid of 19 corners with 6 triangles, 3 pentagons, 3 hexagons and one 9-gon, and every octahedral site a solid of 12 corners with 2 triangles and 6 pentagons. Their volumes are equal at exactly one λ, the single root in this stretch of $1536\lambda^3 + 5184\lambda^2 - 3384\lambda + 11 = 0$ ($\lambda \approx 0.0032669570$), a cubic with no rational root. There both have volume $\sqrt{2}/6$: these are **Sonsam** and **Lahdeli**.
3. $\lambda = 5/24$: the tetrahedral cells are **Ian Durys** (16 corners: 6 triangles, 3 squares, 4 hexagons; volume $13\sqrt{2}/54$) and the octahedral cells are 60° rhombohedra of edge 1/3 (volume $\sqrt{2}/54$), bonded only to Ian Durys.
4. $\lambda = 3/8$: the octahedral cells have shrunk to points; the tetrahedral cells are **Blockheads** (10 corners: 6 triangles, 3 squares, 1 hexagon; volume $\sqrt{2}/4$), four per cell.

On the cubic octet the walk goes from the octet ($\lambda = -1/8$) to cubes ($\lambda = 3/8$) with no stop between, and the equal-volume point is $\lambda = 3/8 - \sqrt[3]{4}/4$, where Samson and Delilah [3] both have volume $\sqrt{2}/6$.

Proof. The census [1] computed every stretch of both walks exactly; checks.py [S] re-derives what the theorem uses from the census engine. On the stretch $(-1/8, 5/24)$ each cell's volume is a cubic polynomial in λ; all four tetrahedral sites give the same one, and $V_{tet} - V_{oct}$ is $-3\sqrt{2}/6144$ times the stated cubic, which is irreducible over $\mathbb{Q}$ and has exactly one root in the stretch. Two octahedral and four tetrahedral pieces fill the cell of volume $\sqrt{2}$, so at equal volume each is $\sqrt{2}/6$. At 5/24 and 3/8 the volumes follow by evaluating the polynomials of the adjacent stretches (they agree from both sides), and the rhombohedron's $\sqrt{2}/54$ is $(1/3)^3/\sqrt{2}$, the volume of a 60° rhombohedron of edge 1/3. The cubic octet's equal-volume point and Samson's and Delilah's volume are checked the same way. All 16 checks pass. □

The webs of bonds. Each stop is a rewiring of the web (bonds per piece, from the census [1]): at the octet, on the cubic side each octahedron bonds to 8 tetrahedra and each tetrahedron to 4 octahedra, while on the twinned side each octahedron bonds to 6 tetrahedra and 2 octahedra (its column) and each tetrahedron to 3 octahedra and 1 tetrahedron (across the mirror plane); at 5/24 on the twinned side each rhombohedron keeps only its 6 bonds to Ian Durys, and each Ian Dury has 3 rhombohedron and 10 Ian Dury bonds; at 3/8 the octahedral sites have dropped out of the web, and the tetrahedral sites are bonded 6 to a cube on the cubic side and 10 to a Blockhead on the twinned side. The equal-volume points are not rewirings: there the web is the one of its stretch, and what is special is the balance of the two kinds. The census [1] lists the bonds of every piece on every stretch.

stop	cubic octet	twinned octet
$\lambda = -1/8$	octahedra + tetrahedra	octahedra + tetrahedra, twinned
equal volume $\sqrt{2}/6$	Samson + Delilah, $\lambda = 3/8 - \sqrt[3]{4}/4$	Sonsam + Lahdeli, root of the cubic
$\lambda = 5/24$	(no stop)	Ian Dury $13\sqrt{2}/54$ + 60° rhombohedron $\sqrt{2}/54$
$\lambda = 3/8$	cubes	Blockheads $\sqrt{2}/4$

Plain words: the mirrored stacking makes the same journey with one extra stop, and every piece on the way has a mirrored twin of a cubic piece.

4. The pieces

Sonsam's nine-sided face lies on a mirror plane of the stacking, between two tetrahedral sites facing each other across it; it is therefore a bond between two Sonsams, and no keying between the two kinds can remove it. **Lahdeli**, with its two triangles and six pentagons, is Delilah's twin; on the cubic side, at the same point of the walk, Delilah is a regular octahedron. **Ian Dury** has only the angles of the cube family (35.26°, 54.74°, 90°, 120°, 135°). **Blockhead** stands where the cubic walk has its cube, and has the same volume √2/4, since both are a quarter of a cell of volume √2. The 60° rhombohedron is classical (two regular tetrahedra and a regular octahedron make one); it is not new and has no new name.

5. Keyed forms

> *Plain words: if two pieces touch, a bump can move from one into a dent in the other, and the pieces still fill space.*

> **Keying lemma.** Let P and Q be pieces of a face-to-face tiling sharing a face F, and K ⊂ P a solid on F. Replacing P, Q by P \ K and Q ∪ K gives again a tiling of space; P \ K and Q ∪ K still meet, and every other contact is unchanged, so the web of bonds is the same. **Proof:** (P \ K) ∪ (Q ∪ K) = P ∪ Q and the two parts do not overlap; K lies in P, so no other piece is touched. □

We applied it to the new pairs with a cone over each shared face, shrunk to 80% about its centre, with apex at the giving piece's centre (option A), or a tetrahedral tooth (option B), both directions; a keying was kept when each piece stayed one solid without holes and the cell volume was conserved. For Sonsam and Lahdeli three keyings pass; DICTO chose Sonsam giving cones to Lahdeli: **Sonsam-K** (≈ 0.1735) and **Lahdeli-K** (≈ 0.3602). For Ian Dury and the rhombohedron three pass; DICTO chose Ian Dury giving cones: **Ian Dury-K** (≈ 0.3111) and **Rhombo-K** (≈ 0.0849), the rhombohedron grown into a six-pointed star (Figure 2). These volumes are floats; the shapes are defined exactly by the rule.

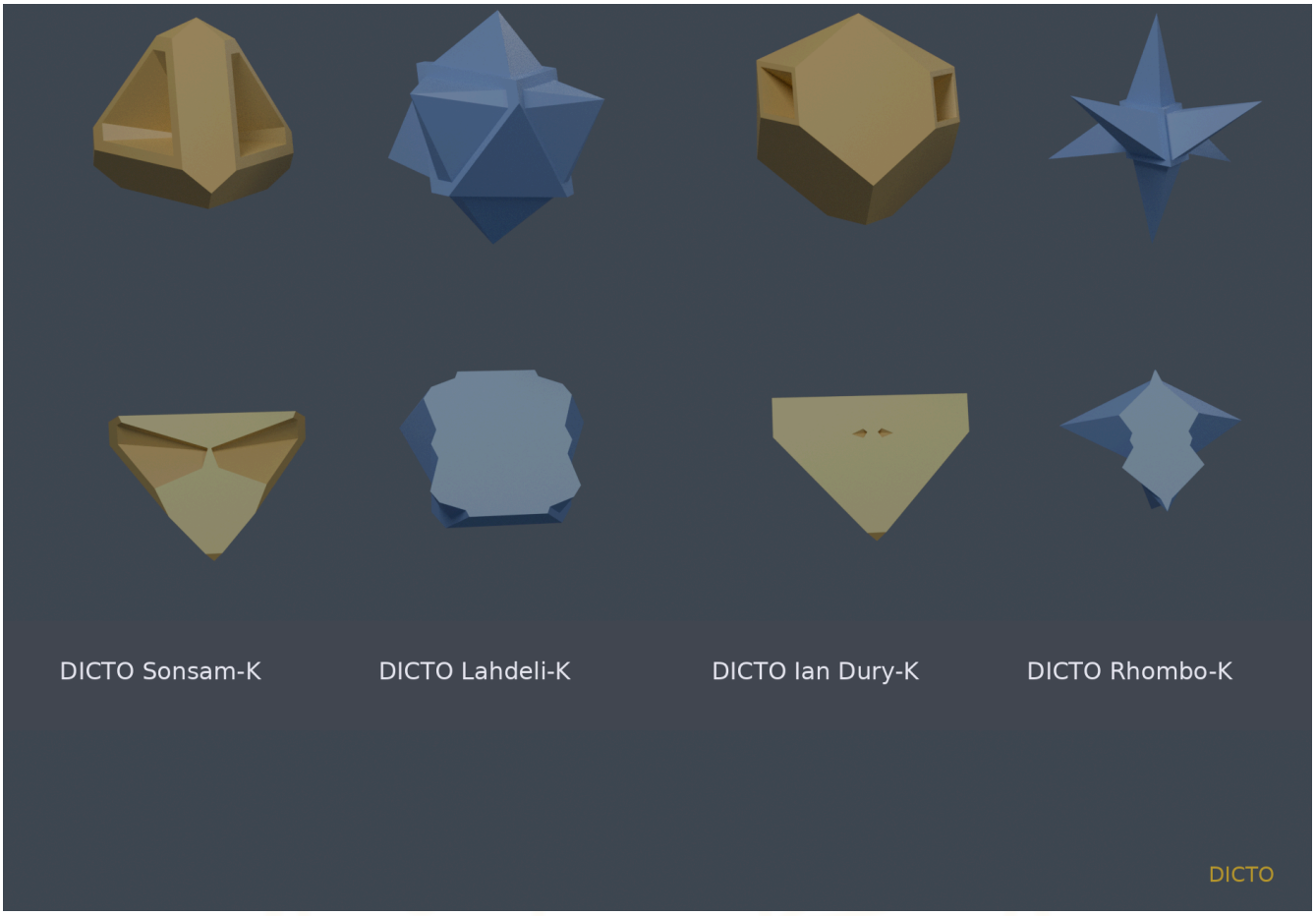


Figure 2. The keyed pairs, whole (top) and cut in half (bottom): Sonsam-K and Lahdeli-K; Ian Dury-K and Rhombo-K.

6. The Sunstar as a keyed switch point

Paper #42 [4] set regular dodecahedra on alternate cubes of a cubic grid, built the dodecahedron as Euclid's cube with a roof on each face [7], and proved that each other cube is filled by a Dogstar, Hart's stellation 8 [8]: the cube minus the six roofs that reach into it. Those facts are #42's. The reading added here joins them to #53: dodecahedra and Dogstars sit on the two sites of rock salt, whose walk has a single switch point where every cell is a cube and only unlike sites are bonded [1]. By the keying lemma, moving each roof from its Dogstar cube to the dodecahedron next to it keeps that switch point's tiling and web: the Sunstar lattice is rock salt's switch point, keyed with Euclid's roofs (Figure 3). With cube edge 2: dodecahedron $10 + 2\sqrt{5}$, each roof $2\varphi/3$, Dogstar $6 - 2\sqrt{5} = 4/\varphi^2$, the two together 16, two cubes; the app's solids agree with cube ± roofs to 10^{-7} [S].

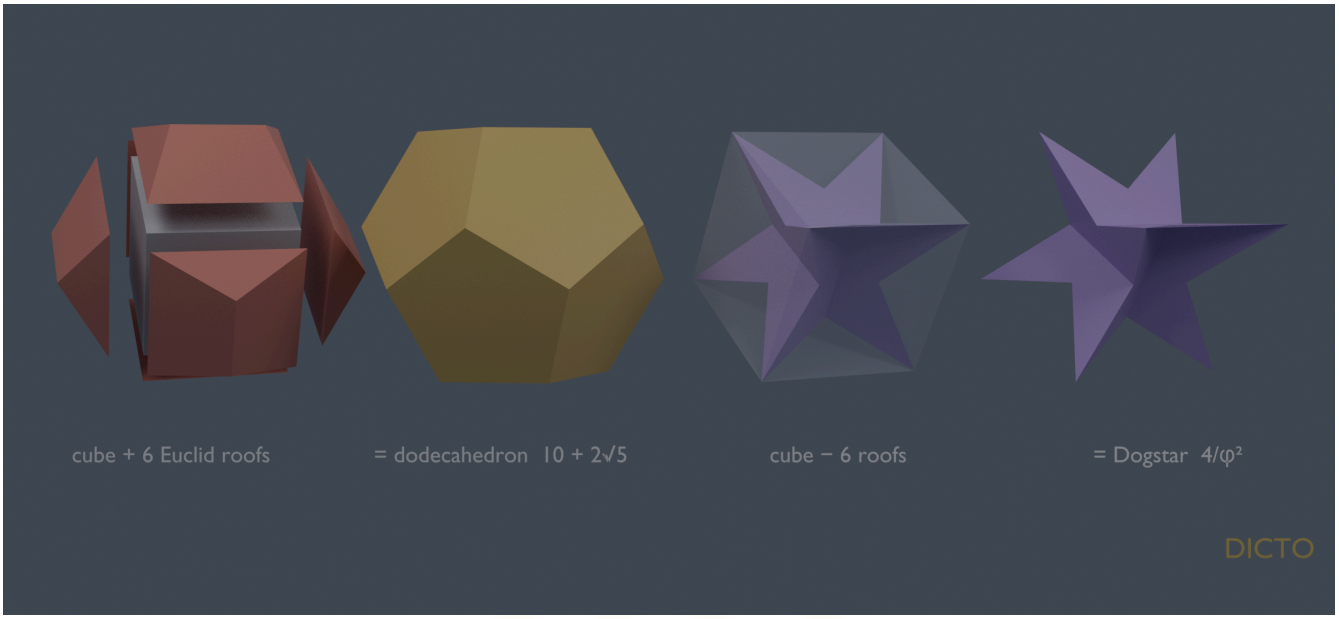


Figure 3. Cube + 6 Euclid roofs = dodecahedron; cube − 6 roofs = Dogstar (#42). In rock salt's switch point every cell is a cube; the roofs are the keys.

7. Open directions

- **A self-keyed Blockhead.** At λ = 3/8 Blockheads touch only Blockheads; keyed through their own faces they would be the twin of DICTO's Hexa-Key, the keyed cube. This needs a choice of which faces give and which receive.
- **Other stackings.** DICTO's OG family was placed on every close-packed stacking (#40); the walk on those stackings would mix Samson, Sonsam and their kin layer by layer.

8. What is known, and what was not found

Known and credited: power diagrams [5]; the census walks, the cubic octet's pieces and Samson and Delilah [1, 3]; the octet and its twinned form; the 60° rhombohedron; Euclid's roofs [7]; the Dogstar and the Sunstar lattice with their exact proofs [4, 8]; the Frank–Kasper cells of the Laves phase. **Not found in the sources checked:** Sonsam, Lahdeli, Ian Dury and Blockhead as solids, the twinned walk's equal-volume point, and the keyed forms; and the reading of the Sunstar lattice as a keyed switch point of rock salt. Searched: DICTO's reference library (four ask-library queries on Voronoi and power cells of the holes of hexagonal close packing), and two web searches, which found descriptions of the holes (number and size) but not of the cells around them. These solids are easy to compute, so an unnamed drawing of them may exist.

References

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[7] Euclid, The Thirteen Books of the Elements, tr. T. L. Heath, vol. III (Books X–XIII), Cambridge (1908), Book XIII, Proposition 17.
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